



GRADE 10- ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

SECTION – WORD AND STRUCTURE KNOWLEDGE

Questions 1–30 | 1 mark each

Q1. Choose the word closest in meaning to “obsolete.”

- A. Modern
- B. Outdated
- C. Original
- D. Valuable

Q2. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “diligent.”

- A. Careful
- B. Hardworking
- C. Negligent
- D. Determined

Q3. Choose the word closest in meaning to “plausible.”

- A. Believable
- B. Impossible
- C. Confusing
- D. Unusual

Q4. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “expand.”

- A. Increase
- B. Develop
- C. Contract
- D. Extend

Q5. Complete the analogy

ORCHESTRA : CONDUCTOR ::

- A. Team : Captain
- B. Book : Author



- C. School : Student
- D. Painting : Museum

Q6. Complete the analogy

THERMOMETER : TEMPERATURE ::

- A. Compass : Distance
- B. Clock : Time
- C. Microscope : Weight
- D. Telescope : Sound

Q7. Choose the correct One-Word Substitution

A person who cannot read or write is:

- A. Anonymous
- B. Illiterate
- C. Introvert
- D. Inarticulate

Q8. Choose the correct one -word substitution.

A person who loves and collects books is called a:

- A. Bibliophile
- B. Biographer
- C. Philosopher
- D. Bibliographer

Q9. Choose the correctly spelt word.

- A. Exaggerate
- B. Exagerrate
- C. Exagerate
- D. Exaggerete

Q10. Choose the correctly spelt word.

- A. Maintenance
- B. Maintainance



- C. Maintenance
- D. Maintanence

Q11. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:

The athlete ran extremely quickly.

- A. Adjective
- B. Adverb
- C. Noun
- D. Pronoun

Q12. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:

The poor deserve our support.

- A. Adjective used as a noun
- B. Adverb
- C. Preposition
- D. Conjunction

Q13. The manager was impressed ____ her presentation.

- A. at
- B. by
- C. for
- D. with

Q14. He has been absent ____ school for three days.

- A. from
- B. at
- C. by
- D. of

Q15. Work hard ____ you will not achieve your desired result.

- A. and
- B. or
- C. but
- D. because

Q16. She continued speaking ____ nobody appeared to be listening.



- A. even though
- B. so that
- C. unless
- D. therefore

Q17. When I reached the station, the train ____.

- A. leaves
- B. has left
- C. had left
- D. will leave

Q18. They ____ the house for five years before deciding to sell it.

- A. own
- B. have owned
- C. had owned
- D. are owning

Q19. Choose the correct passive form:

The committee is reviewing the proposal.

- A. The proposal reviewed the committee.
- B. The proposal is being reviewed by the committee.
- C. The proposal has reviewed by the committee.
- D. The proposal was being reviewed by the committee.

Q20. Choose the correct active form:

The match was won by our school team.

- A. Our school team wins the match.
- B. Our school team has won the match.
- C. Our school team won the match.
- D. Our school team was winning the match.

Q21. You ____ submit the application before Friday; otherwise, it will not be considered.

- A. may
- B. must



- C. could
- D. might

Q22. She ____ be at home; I saw her leave the building ten minutes ago.

- A. must
- B. can't
- C. should
- D. ought to

Q23. Choose the correct question.

- A. How long have you been waiting here?
- B. How long you have been waiting here?
- C. How long did you been waiting here?
- D. How long have been you waiting here?

Q24. Choose the correct question tag:

Let's discuss the matter later, ____?

- A. will we?
- B. shall we?
- C. do we?
- D. aren't we?

Q25. The investigators are trying to ____ the cause of the accident.

- A. find out
- B. find over
- C. find up
- D. find off

Q26. The students ____ the instructions before beginning the experiment.

- A. went through
- B. went against
- C. went off
- D. went over to

Q27. If something happens "at the eleventh hour," it happens:



- A. very early
- B. exactly at eleven o'clock
- C. at the last possible moment
- D. without warning

Q28. To “hit the nail on the head” means to:

- A. make a serious mistake
- B. describe something exactly
- C. avoid a difficult situation
- D. work extremely hard

Q29. Choose the correct collocation.

- A. Make progress
- B. Do progress
- C. Build progress
- D. Create progress

Q30. Choose the correct word:

The school will ____ a new policy next term.

- A. adapt
- B. adopt
- C. adept
- D. admit

SECTION 2 – READING

Questions 31–40 | 1 mark each

THE ART OF LISTENING

In conversations, people often prepare their responses while the other person is still speaking. As a result, they may hear the words but fail to understand the meaning behind them. Genuine listening requires more than simply remaining silent while someone else talks.

An attentive listener tries to understand both the information being communicated and the speaker's perspective. This may involve asking questions, noticing changes in tone and considering what has been left unsaid. Such attention does not necessarily mean agreeing with the speaker. A person can understand an argument without accepting it.



Good listening is particularly important when disagreements arise. If people immediately assume that their opponents are wrong, they may overlook information that could help them find common ground. Listening carefully can reveal that two apparently opposing positions share some underlying concerns.

However, listening is not always easy. Distractions, impatience and preconceived ideas can interfere with understanding. The listener may also become so focused on preparing a reply that important details are missed.

Developing the habit of listening carefully can therefore improve not only conversations but also decision-making. When people understand before responding, they are more likely to respond thoughtfully rather than simply react.

Q31. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Speaking is more important than listening.
- B. Good listening requires active attention and can improve communication.
- C. People should always agree with one another.
- D. Arguments should always be avoided.

Q32. According to the passage, genuine listening involves:

- A. remaining completely silent
- B. preparing a response while someone speaks
- C. understanding the speaker's meaning and perspective
- D. agreeing with everything the speaker says

Q33. Why is listening useful during disagreements?

- A. It guarantees that everyone will agree.
- B. It may reveal shared concerns between opposing positions.
- C. It allows one person to dominate the discussion.
- D. It prevents people from expressing their opinions.

Q34. The word "preconceived" most nearly means:

- A. carefully researched
- B. formed beforehand
- C. recently discovered
- D. completely forgotten

Q35. Which of the following is mentioned as an obstacle to listening?



- A. Curiosity
- B. Patience
- C. Distraction
- D. Agreement

Q36. What does the sentence *"A person can understand an argument without accepting it"* imply?

- A. Understanding and agreement are different.
- B. Arguments should never be accepted.
- C. Listening requires agreement.
- D. People cannot understand opposing opinions.

Q37. Which statement is NOT supported by the passage?

- A. Listening can improve decision-making.
- B. People sometimes prepare replies while others are speaking.
- C. Good listeners must agree with the speaker.
- D. Tone can provide useful information.

Q38. The author's tone is best described as:

- A. Informative
- B. Humorous
- C. Angry
- D. Sarcastic

Q39. Which title BEST fits the passage?

- A. Winning Every Argument
- B. Why Speaking Is Difficult
- C. Listening Before Responding
- D. The Problems of Conversation

Q40. What can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Careful listening may reduce impulsive responses.
- B. Listening is useful only during arguments.
- C. People who listen carefully never disagree.
- D. Silence is the same as effective listening.

SECTION 3 – SPOKEN & WRITTEN EXPRESSION



Questions 41–45 | 1 mark each

Q41. Which sentence is most appropriate for a formal debate?

- A. This idea is totally ridiculous.
- B. I don't really agree with this stuff.
- C. The opposing argument overlooks several important factors.
- D. You guys haven't thought this through.

Q42. Choose the most appropriate formal expression.

- A. I want you to fix this immediately.
- B. I would appreciate it if the issue could be resolved at the earliest opportunity.
- C. You better sort this out.
- D. Fix this as soon as possible, okay?

Q43. Choose the most suitable connector:

The experiment produced promising results. ____, further testing is necessary before a conclusion can be reached.

- A. Therefore
- B. Nevertheless
- C. Similarly
- D. For example

Q44. Choose the sentence with the clearest expression.

- A. The plan was good because it had many good things in it.
- B. The plan was effective because it addressed the major concerns identified by the committee.
- C. The plan was really good and everyone thought it was great.
- D. The plan had some things that were nice for everyone.

Q45. Which sentence is most appropriate for an academic article?

- A. Pollution is a huge problem and everyone knows it.
- B. Pollution is really bad for people and the planet.
- C. Increasing levels of pollution pose significant risks to both public health and ecosystems.
- D. Pollution is causing lots of trouble everywhere.

SECTION 4 – ACHIEVERS SECTION

Questions 46–50 | 3 marks each



Q46. Choose the sentence that is grammatically correct.

- A. Despite he was tired, he completed the assignment.
- B. Despite of being tired, he completed the assignment.
- C. Despite being tired, he completed the assignment.
- D. Despite he being tired, but he completed the assignment.

Q47. Choose the correct reported speech:

Rohan said, "I have completed my project."

- A. Rohan said that I have completed my project.
- B. Rohan said that he had completed his project.
- C. Rohan said that he has completed my project.
- D. Rohan said that I had completed his project.

Q48. Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence:

If I ____ about the change earlier, I would have prepared differently.

- A. know
- B. knew
- C. had known
- D. have known

49. Identify the sentence with the correct use of the modifier.

- A. Walking through the park, the colourful flowers attracted Maya.
- B. Walking through the park, Maya admired the colourful flowers.
- C. The colourful flowers, walking through the park, attracted Maya.
- D. Maya, the colourful flowers attracted while walking through the park.

50. Read the passage carefully:

Online learning has made education accessible to students who may otherwise face geographical or scheduling difficulties. However, access to information alone does not guarantee effective learning. Students also need opportunities to ask questions, receive feedback and remain engaged with the material. Therefore, the success of online education depends not simply on providing digital resources but on designing learning experiences that support meaningful interaction.

Which conclusion is BEST supported?



- A. Online education is less effective than traditional education in every situation.
- B. Providing students with digital resources is sufficient for successful learning.
- C. Effective online education requires both technological access and meaningful learning support.
- D. Students should avoid online education whenever possible.

ANSWER

- 1. **B**
- 2. **C**
- 3. **A**
- 4. **C**
- 5. **A**
- 6. **B**
- 7. **B**



8. A

9. A

10. A

11. B

12. A

13. B

14. A

15. B

16. A

17. C

18. C

19. B

20. C

21. B

22. B

23. A

24. B

25. A

26. A

27. C

28. B

29. A

30. B

31. B



32. C

33. B

34. B

35. C

36. A

37. C

38. A

39. C

40. A

41. C

42. B

43. B

44. B

45. C

46. C

47. B

48. C

49. B

50. C